

SECURITY CONCERNS COMPEL WEST BENGAL TO ORDER CHOPPERS



BHATTACHARYA

KOLKATA | Whirly Bid

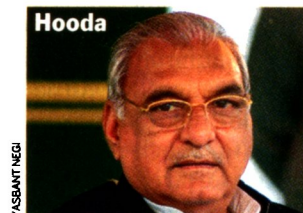
Even high level security is not beyond the clutches of protocol and form. The threat to West Bengal Chief Minister Buddhadeb Bhattacharya's security has risen sharply after the Shalboni Maoist attack on the cars carrying him and Ram Vilas Paswan two months ago. The state Government has finally got its act together and has decided to buy a chopper for the chief minister and other VIP ministers who have similar security concerns. The Home Department has already ordered a Pawan Hans chopper but this has raised the hackles of the Transport Ministry which feels that the procurement should have been passed through the Transport Minister Subhas Chakraborty's hands. Last heard, all decks have been cleared for the purchase.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

Dole Days

In a move to dent anti-incumbency ahead of the Lok Sabha elections, Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda has announced incentives worth Rs 700 crore for a dozen categories of beneficiaries. Interesti-

Hooda



YASBANT NEGI

ngly, Hooda's largesse, to be effective from April 1, unfolded during the Budget session but is not part of the Budget.

by Ramesh Vinayak

200

Shiv Sena activists attended the three-day etiquette camp.



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SHIV SENA WORKERS

Past Track

Former Karnataka chief minister S. Bangarappa is all set to make a comeback to the Congress. He will be meeting Congress chief Sonia Gandhi soon to join formally. Meanwhile, Chief



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Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa is thinking of fielding his son from Shimoga, Bangarappa's home turf, in the Lok Sabha polls.

by Stephen David

MUMBAI | Sainiks and Gentlemen

Shiv Sainiks are all set to get a verbal makeover. Realising the importance of public speaking, the party conducted a three-day etiquette camp for its workers this week. Over 200 party activists, including district office-bearers, attended the camp where speakers were given lessons in public speaking, body language, election issues and the party's official stand on current topics. "The camp was for party workers who do not have political backing or experience in interacting with people or the media," says Neelam

Gorhe, spokesperson of the Sena. Besides taking in-house help from their senior leaders, the party hired the services of a professional agency, Prasanna HRD Private Limited, to design the course. "The camp was to teach these young people the importance of public speaking and interacting with the voters," says Gorhe who was also one of the speakers. The change, say party members, reflects Executive President Uddhav Thackeray's contemporary approach.

by Aditi Pai